



Muncie Sanitary August 24, 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2URkhy4GSMI
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Report: Board of Sanitary Commissioners (Muncie Sanitary District)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Board of Sanitary Commissioners for the Muncie Sanitary District was called to order on August 24, 2022, by the presiding officer in the City Hall Auditorium.
- **Attendance:** All four commissioners were present, establishing a quorum. There were no excused absences.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The board reviewed and approved the minutes from the August 10, 2022, board meeting as submitted (Approved by Voice Vote).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:18 Consideration of the Register of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board leadership and staff.

- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed claims totaling \$2,021,258.32. Staff highlighted several major payments for the benefit of the public: \$208,350 to APGN Inc. for a turbo blower at the treatment facility; \$15,655.61 to Greeley and Hansen for Walnut Street sewer design work, plus \$9,049.12 for Alt Shire work; and \$1,183,400 to Bowen Engineering (Payment No. 13) for ongoing bond-funded projects.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:17:31 Dave Osborne**
 - **Affiliation:** Former Director of Engineering, Muncie Sanitary District (retiree with 34 years of service).
 - **Key Concerns:** Addressed the board regarding spousal health insurance coverage. He stated that upon becoming eligible for Medicare, his wife was removed from the district's insurance plan. He recently learned that employees who retired after him were permitted to maintain spousal coverage, and he requested that the board consider reinstating his wife onto the district's health insurance policy. Board leadership agreed to look into the inquiry and follow up directly.
 - **00:24:24 Rick Yancer**
 - **Affiliation:** Former newsman, author, and local businessperson.
 - **Key Concerns:** Questioned the allocation of American Rescue Plan (ARP) funds, specifically noting a recent ~\$7 million claim approved by the city for the Sanitary District, questioning why one government entity is funding another rather than distributing direct relief. He also raised concerns about rising property taxes (up 5<U+2013>10% in the area), increasing public debt for local projects (such as a sanitation garage and school stadium), and noted a decline or gap in local cardboard recycling efforts following the sale of Rock Tenn.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **District Administrator Update (00:03:15):** John Barlow reported that Jackson Street closures (at Tally and College) are ongoing, with an estimated two weeks remaining. Surveying has also begun in the Drum edition for an upcoming drainage project. Furthermore, Barlow provided updates on ongoing long-term contract negotiations with the Delaware Regional Wastewater District (their largest wholesale customer), noting they are very close to a tentative agreement.

- **Contractor / Construction Update (00:05:16):** Tom Noble, assistant superintendent and construction crew manager, reported that the in-house 5-person crew has completed 107 jobs year-to-date. He addressed public questions regarding why utility projects stop at certain points, explaining that work is tied to logical termini (manhole-to-manhole) and coordination with the city's paving schedule. He also noted current staff vacancies for a sewer driver and a construction crew member.
 - **Board Recognition:** The board celebrated District Administrator John Barlow starting his 40th year of service with the Muncie Sanitary District.
 - **Next Meeting:** Scheduled for Wednesday, September 7, 2022, at 11:30 AM in the City Hall Auditorium.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Tanya and a second by Adam (Approved by Voice Vote).
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